

VARSHA SATHYANARANAN

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Profile

Commercial merchandiser with 4+ years of experience in buying, assortment planning, and P&L management across omnichannel retail. Proven track record of scaling categories from zero to ₹3.5 lakh revenue in 2 months, improving margins from 22% to 35% through vendor negotiation, and reducing stock-outs by 20% via data-driven assortment optimization. Skilled in OTB planning, vendor management across 20+ suppliers, and advanced Excel for dashboards and WIP tracking. Ready to drive sell-through and vendor compliance for fast-fashion womenswear in a fast-paced omnichannel environment.

Competencies

Core Competencies:

Tools:

Functional Strengths:

Experience

Category Manager - Fashion

SuperK, Bangalore, India
Nov 2025 - Present

Built the fashion category from near zero across online channels and a tech-enabled retail network of 3+ company-owned stores, launching assortments across apparel, footwear, and accessories while driving vendor expansion, category P&L ownership, and data-led merchandising decisions.

- Expanded the fashion assortment from 5 to 25+ subcategories across menswear, womenswear, kidswear, footwear, and accessories by onboarding 12+ regional vendors, identifying assortment gaps, and benchmarking category offerings against value retail players like DMart and Vishal Mega Mart.
- Generated ₹3.5 lakh in category revenue within two months by analyzing weekly sales performance, pricing benchmarks, and customer demand signals.
- Negotiated vendor pricing, MOQs, and sourcing terms, improving product margins from 22% to 35% while maintaining competitive retail pricing.
- Partnered with marketing teams to launch fashion-led campaigns during New Year, Pongal and Republic Day, increasing category visibility by ~22% and driving ~15% uplift in campaign period sales.
- Collaborated with operations and supply chain teams to improve stock availability for fast-moving SKUs, coordinating warehouse invoicing and inventory flow to reduce stock-outs by ~20% across priority products.
- Tracked sell-through, AOV, and margin performance using Excel and Metabase dashboards; identified underperforming SKUs and implemented assortment rationalization that improved category gross margin by ~6%.

Founder

The Style Gram, Remote - Chennai, India

Nov 2024 - Jun 2025

Built and operated a lean fashion reselling brand focused on affordable women's western-wear, managing end-to-end sourcing, merchandising, content creation, and customer engagement across Instagram and Swiggy Minis.

- Generated ₹50,000 in revenue during the launch phase with an average order value of ₹600, fulfilling 80+ customer orders across Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities with zero product returns.
- Sourced and merchandised 60+ SKUs across tops, skirts, and dresses through direct supplier negotiations, maintaining 45% gross margins and reducing sourcing turnaround time by 25%.
- Evaluated and engaged 5 supplier partners before finalizing a primary vendor to optimize pricing, quality consistency, and procurement turnaround time.
- Executed pricing, merchandising, and inventory tracking through Excel-based systems, ensuring 100% order fulfillment and streamlined stock management.
- Managed 60+ SKUs on Swiggy Minis and built a custom Excel-based WIP tracker to manage catalog listings, order tracking, and inventory visibility, reducing catalog errors by 90% and improving stock flow for fast-selling styles.
- Produced 25+ branded content assets and launched 3+ Instagram ad campaigns, improving click-through rates by 22% through A/B testing and targeted messaging.

Assistant Fashion Manager

Go Colors (Go Fashion India Ltd.), Chennai, India

Sept 2020 - June 2023

Supported buying and merchandising for women's and girls' bottom-wear categories including leggings, track pants, formal pants, ethnic bottoms, and shorts, with responsibility for vendor coordination, product lifecycle execution, and data-led assortment decisions.

- Managed PO/PI coordination and vendor communication across 20+ suppliers and 10+ factories across India and Asia, ensuring 95% on-time delivery for seasonal production orders.
- Analyzed weekly sales performance for 200+ SKUs, recommending replenishment and assortment adjustments that improved category sell-through by 15%.
- Aligned assortment planning with trend insights and performance data, driving a 10% lift in customer purchase rate across key bottom-wear categories.
- Launched 3+ new sub-categories including kids-wear, leading a 2-member team to introduce new styles and revamp existing collections, boosting category sales by 15% in the first quarter.
- Negotiated supplier pricing and MOQs during fabric sourcing and production planning, maintaining product quality while ensuring competitive margins.
- Led sampling, fit approvals, and production coordination for 30+ styles per season, reducing post-launch return rates to under 10% while gaining exposure to PLM-driven product development workflows.
- Built WIP trackers to monitor production timelines and collaborated with logistics, VM, and marketing teams to ensure timely product launches.

Key Achievements

Education

Humber College, Longo School of Business

Graduate Certificate in Fashion Management

Toronto, Canada | Sept 2023, Aug 2024

National Institute of Fashion Technology NIFT

Bachelor of Design, Fashion Design

Chennai, India | July 2016, July 2020

Skills

Core Competencies:	OTB & Assortment Planning · Fashion Buying & Category Management · PO/PI Coordination & Vendor Management · Inventory Control & Forecasting · TNA Calendar Tracking · Product Lifecycle Management (PLM) · Order Tracking & Sell-Through Analysis
Tools:	Advanced MS Excel (VLOOKUP, Pivot Tables, Dashboards) · MS Word · Google Sheets · Canva · Meta Ads Manager · SAP (PO/Inventory Tracking - Basic)
Functional Strengths:	Cross-Functional Collaboration · Trend Analysis & Data-Driven Decision-Making · Sales Performance Reporting · Catalog & Content Management · E-commerce Marketing · Vendor Negotiation & Cost Optimization